

D224

# Global and Population Health

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

**What this is.** Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

**Source.** Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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# How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | _____  |                               |

# Items

1.

A public health nurse in a county with a new bike trail runs a mammogram screening event for women aged 50 to 74. The event is sponsored by a local bakery. Which level of prevention is this?

- A. Secondary prevention
- B. Tertiary prevention
- C. Primary prevention
- D. Primary, because the event is sponsored and free

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity is primary prevention?

- A. Any nursing activity done in the community
- B. A flu vaccination clinic
- C. Cardiac rehab after a heart attack
- D. A blood pressure screening booth

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

3.

A town of 20,000 with a new community center had 400 residents living with type 2 diabetes on January 1. During the year, 100 new cases were diagnosed. The town's mayor is a retired nurse. Using the total population as the denominator, what is the annual incidence per 1,000?

- A. 5 per 1,000
- B. 0.5 per 1,000
- C. 20 per 1,000
- D. 25 per 1,000

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**4.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a city of 50,000, asthma prevalence is 40 per 1,000 people. How many people currently have asthma?

- A.** 1,250
- B.** 40
- C.** 2,000
- D.** It can't be known without the number of new cases.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**5.**

A nurse at a clinic that recently extended its hours sees a patient whose asthma keeps flaring. She lives in a moldy apartment near a highway and cannot afford her inhaler copay. She is a devoted youth soccer coach. Which factors are social determinants of health?

- A.** Her genetic tendency toward asthma
- B.** Her coaching schedule
- C.** Only her medication adherence
- D.** Her housing conditions and her income for medication

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**6.**

During a norovirus outbreak on a cruise ship with 3,000 passengers and a newly renovated theater, investigators note the virus, crowded dining halls, and many older passengers with weaker immunity. In the epidemiologic triangle, what are the crowded dining halls?

- A.** Host
- B.** Environment
- C.** Portal of entry
- D.** Agent

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

7.

At a bus crash near a stadium, a nurse using START triage finds an adult who cannot walk and is breathing 36 times a minute. The bus was chartered by a church group. Which tag does the patient get?

- A. Yellow (delayed)
- B. Black (expectant)
- C. Red (immediate)
- D. Green (minor)

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under START triage, which patient receives a green (minor) tag?

- A. Any patient under age 8
- B. A patient breathing 40 times a minute
- C. A patient who does not breathe after the airway is repositioned
- D. A patient who can walk to the collection area when directed

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

9.

A school district with a new STEM wing reports measles vaccination coverage fell from 96% to 88%. Its football team won the state title. What is the main population health concern?

- A. Only unvaccinated students are at risk.
- B. Coverage is now below the herd immunity threshold, so outbreaks become possible and those who can't be vaccinated lose protection.
- C. No concern, since any coverage above 50% protects everyone.
- D. The concern is vaccinated students spreading measles.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

10.

A health department with a \$200,000 grant and a new logo gives every neighborhood the same number of free blood pressure screenings, although one neighborhood has triple the hypertension rate and no pharmacy. Which approach reflects health equity?

- A. Give the high-need neighborhood fewer screenings, since it has no pharmacy to follow up.
- B. Keep giving every neighborhood the same number of screenings.
- C. Divide screenings by population size only.
- D. Direct more resources to the neighborhood with greater need and fewer services.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement describes equality rather than equity?

- A. Clinics serving many non-English speakers get extra interpreters.
- B. A mobile clinic is sent to an area without public transport.
- C. Every clinic receives identical funding regardless of patient need.
- D. Equality and equity always lead to the same outcomes.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

12.

A public health nurse in a town with a historic downtown visits a family whose 2-year-old has an elevated blood lead level. They live in a house built in 1940 with peeling paint. The father works as an accountant. What is the most likely source and priority action?

- A. Lead paint dust and chips; arrange a home assessment and remediation, and follow-up testing.
- B. Wait for symptoms, since lead exposure always causes obvious signs first.
- C. Dust carried home from the father's workplace
- D. Drinking water only; switch to bottled water and take no other action.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

# STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

# Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

## 1. Answer A Concept 1

A public health nurse ~~in a county with a new bike trail~~ runs a mammogram screening event for women aged 50 to 74. ~~The event is sponsored by a local bakery.~~ Which level of prevention is this?

**Target word:** level of prevention **Decides:** Screening finds disease early.

|   |                   |                                                          |
|---|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>    | Screening detects existing disease early.                |
| B | Adjacent category | Tertiary limits harm after diagnosis.                    |
| C | Confusion set     | Primary prevents disease from starting (e.g., vaccines). |
| D | Camouflage        | Sponsorship does not change the level.                   |

## 2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which activity is primary prevention?

**Target word:** identify primary **Decides:** Prevents disease before it occurs.

|   |                   |                                             |
|---|-------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| A | Absolute language | Setting does not define the level.          |
| B | <b>Correct</b>    | Vaccination prevents disease from starting. |
| C | Adjacent category | Rehab after disease is tertiary.            |
| D | Confusion set     | Screening is secondary.                     |

## 3. Answer A Concept 2

A town of 20,000 ~~with a new community center~~ had 400 residents living with type 2 diabetes on January 1. During the year, 100 new cases were diagnosed. ~~The town's mayor is a retired nurse.~~ Using the total population as the denominator, what is the annual incidence per 1,000?

**Target word:** incidence rate **Decides:** Only the 100 new cases count.

|   |                    |                                               |
|---|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | $100 \div 20,000 \times 1,000 = 5$ .          |
| B | Inverted operation | Scales per 100 people instead of per 1,000.   |
| C | Confusion set      | $400 \div 20,000$ is prevalence on January 1. |
| D | Adjacent category  | $500 \div 20,000$ is year-end prevalence.     |

## 4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

In a city of 50,000, asthma prevalence is 40 per 1,000 people. How many people currently have asthma?

**Target word:** solve for number of cases **Decides:**  $40 \div 1,000 \times 50,000$ .

|   |                    |                                               |
|---|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| A | Inverted operation | Divides 50,000 by 40.                         |
| B | Wrong stem number  | That is the rate, not the count.              |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | $0.04 \times 50,000 = 2,000$ .                |
| D | Confusion set      | Prevalence already counts all existing cases. |

## 5. Answer D Concept 3

A nurse at a clinic ~~that recently extended its hours~~ sees a patient whose asthma keeps flaring. She lives in a moldy apartment near a highway and cannot afford her inhaler copay. ~~She is a devoted youth soccer coach.~~ Which factors are social determinants of health?

**Target word:** identify SDOH **Decides:** Housing conditions and income.

|   |                   |                                                            |
|---|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Adjacent category | Genetics is a biological factor.                           |
| B | Camouflage        | Not a driver of her flares here.                           |
| C | Dropped element   | Leaves out the housing and cost barriers behind adherence. |
| D | <b>Correct</b>    | Where she lives and what she can afford are SDOH.          |

## 6. Answer B Concept 4

During a norovirus outbreak on a cruise ship ~~with 3,000 passengers and a newly renovated theater~~, investigators note the virus, crowded dining halls, and many older passengers with weaker immunity. In the epidemiologic triangle, what are the crowded dining halls?

**Target word:** triangle element **Decides:** An external condition that allows spread.

|   |                   |                                                         |
|---|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Confusion set     | Hosts are the passengers and their susceptibility.      |
| B | <b>Correct</b>    | External conditions that bring agent and host together. |
| C | Adjacent category | A link in the chain of infection, not the triangle.     |
| D | Confusion set     | The agent is the norovirus.                             |

## 7. Answer C Concept 5

At a bus crash ~~near a stadium~~, a nurse using START triage finds an adult who cannot walk and is breathing 36 times a minute. ~~The bus was chartered by a church group.~~ Which tag does the patient get?

**Target word:** START tag **Decides:** Respiratory rate over 30.

|   |                    |                                                                        |
|---|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Confusion set      | Yellow requires $RR \leq 30$ , good perfusion, and following commands. |
| B | Adjacent category  | Black is for no breathing after the airway is opened.                  |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | $RR > 30$ is an immediate category.                                    |
| D | Inverted operation | Green is for those who can walk.                                       |

## 8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Under START triage, which patient receives a green (minor) tag?

**Target word:** who is green **Decides:** Able to walk.

|   |                    |                                                                |
|---|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Absolute language  | Age alone does not assign a tag; children use a modified tool. |
| B | Inverted operation | $RR > 30$ is red.                                              |
| C | Confusion set      | That patient is tagged black.                                  |
| D | <b>Correct</b>     | Walking wounded are green.                                     |

### 9. Answer B Concept 6

A school district ~~with a new STEM wing~~ reports measles vaccination coverage fell from 96% to 88%. ~~Its football team won the state title.~~ What is the main population health concern?

**Target word:** herd immunity risk **Decides:** 88% is below the ~95% measles threshold.

|          |                    |                                                        |
|----------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Dropped element    | Leaves out infants and people who can't be vaccinated. |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Measles needs about 95% coverage.                      |
| C        | Absolute language  | Thresholds depend on how contagious the disease is.    |
| D        | Inverted operation | Risk rises from the unvaccinated gap.                  |

### 10. Answer D Concept 7

A health department ~~with a \$200,000 grant and a new logo~~ gives every neighborhood the same number of free blood pressure screenings, although one neighborhood has triple the hypertension rate and no pharmacy. Which approach reflects health equity?

**Target word:** equitable allocation **Decides:** Need is unequal.

|          |                    |                                        |
|----------|--------------------|----------------------------------------|
| A        | Inverted operation | Deepens the gap.                       |
| B        | Confusion set      | That is equality, not equity.          |
| C        | Dropped element    | Ignores differences in disease burden. |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Equity matches resources to need.      |

### 11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

Which statement describes equality rather than equity?

**Target word:** spot equality **Decides:** Same resources regardless of need.

|          |                   |                                           |
|----------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set     | That adjusts to need, which is equity.    |
| B        | Confusion set     | Targeted to need = equity.                |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Equal shares without regard to need.      |
| D        | Absolute language | Equal inputs often keep unequal outcomes. |

### 12. Answer A Concept 8

A public health nurse ~~in a town with a historic downtown~~ visits a family whose 2-year-old has an elevated blood lead level. They live in a house built in 1940 with peeling paint. ~~The father works as an accountant.~~ What is the most likely source and priority action?

**Target word:** source and intervention **Decides:** Old house with deteriorating paint and a toddler.

|          |                   |                                                            |
|----------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Removing the source is the priority.                       |
| B        | Absolute language | Lead poisoning is often silent.                            |
| C        | Camouflage        | An office job is not a lead source.                        |
| D        | Adjacent category | Water can matter, but the paint is the likely main source. |

## Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

|                       | Right                                                 | Wrong                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                                | <b>Concept inversion — top priority.</b> A wrong mental model; it survives rewording. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer. | Not learned yet.                                                                      |

## Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

| Trap               | What it does                                                 | In this drill | Your misses |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|
| Dropped element    | Leaves out a required term or step.                          | 3             |             |
| Wrong stem number  | A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.      | 1             |             |
| Adjacent category  | The right idea in the wrong bucket.                          | 7             |             |
| Inverted operation | Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower. | 6             |             |
| Absolute language  | Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.           | 5             |             |
| Confusion set      | Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.       | 11            |             |
| Camouflage         | Answers a stem fact that was never the question.             | 3             |             |

## Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

| # | Concept                              | Rule                                                                                                                                                                    | Trap                                                   | Tell                                                 |
|---|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Levels of prevention</b>          | Primary prevents disease before it starts; secondary detects it early (screening); tertiary limits harm from existing disease (rehab).                                  | Calling screening primary prevention.                  | Is the disease absent, hidden, or already diagnosed? |
| 2 | <b>Incidence vs. prevalence</b>      | Incidence = new cases in a period ÷ population; prevalence = all existing cases at a point ÷ population.                                                                | Counting existing cases as new ones.                   | “New cases” vs. “living with.”                       |
| 3 | <b>Social determinants of health</b> | SDOH are the conditions where people live, work, and play — housing, income, education, transport — that shape health.                                                  | Listing genetics or personal choices as SDOH.          | Housing, money, neighborhood, access.                |
| 4 | <b>Epidemiologic triangle</b>        | Disease arises from agent (the cause), host (the person and susceptibility), and environment (external conditions that allow spread).                                   | Labeling crowding as a host factor.                    | Classify one factor in an outbreak.                  |
| 5 | <b>START mass casualty triage</b>    | Walking = green; not breathing after airway opened = black; RR > 30, poor perfusion, or can't follow commands = red; others = yellow.                                   | Tagging a fast-breathing patient yellow.               | A respiratory rate and whether the person can walk.  |
| 6 | <b>Herd immunity</b>                 | When coverage falls below a disease's threshold (about 95% for measles), outbreaks become possible and those who can't be vaccinated lose protection.                   | Thinking any majority coverage protects everyone.      | Falling vaccination rates.                           |
| 7 | <b>Equity vs. equality</b>           | Equality gives everyone the same; equity gives more to those with greater need to reach fair outcomes.                                                                  | Calling equal shares equitable.                        | Unequal need with equal resources.                   |
| 8 | <b>Environmental health: lead</b>    | In young children, lead exposure most often comes from deteriorating lead paint in pre-1978 housing; exposure is often silent, so testing and home remediation are key. | Waiting for symptoms or focusing on unrelated sources. | Old housing, peeling paint, a toddler.               |

**Course scope (public description):** Global and Population Health prepares students for the role of the nurse in preserving and promoting health among diverse populations. Additionally, basic principles of epidemiology, social determinants of health (SDOH), and resource allocation through value-based care are outlined. The course introduces planning, organization, and delivery of services for diverse populations in community settings, including illness prevention, disaster preparedness, and environmental health. All prior courses in the sequence for this program serve as prerequisites for this course. This course is eligible for an In Progress grade. Please see the Grading Scale Policy for more information.